

Brussels, June 19 – At the last plenary session, members of the European Data Protection Board (EDPB) elected Zdravko Vukić, Director of the Personal Data Protection Agency, as the Deputy Chair of the European Data Protection Board. Director Vukić will replace Aleid Wolfsen (Chair of the Dutch Data Protection Authority), whose five-year term has expired. Over the coming years, Zdravko Vukić, along with his colleague Irene Loizidou Nikolaidou, Commissioner of the Cypriot Data Protection Authority, will closely collaborate with the Chair of the European Data Protection Board, Anu Talus, to ensure the consistent application of EU data protection rules and to promote effective cooperation among data protection authorities across the European Economic Area (EEA).

The newly elected Deputy Chair of the European Data Protection Board, Zdravko Vukić, stated: “I am honored and grateful to be elected as Deputy Chair of the EDPB. The European Data Protection Board is a prominent and influential EU decision-making body that plays a key role in shaping the digital society in accordance with the shared values of the EU. All members of the European Data Protection Board work closely together to raise awareness of the General Data Protection Regulation at the national and EU levels, enabling individuals to exercise their rights and helping organizations, including small businesses, to understand their obligations. My responsibility as Deputy Chair is to continue achieving these goals, and I will be committed to strengthening mutual cooperation so that we can respond to new challenges with innovative approaches and tools. To achieve these results, we must ensure that data protection authorities and the Secretariat of the European Data Protection Board, which serves as a key link among the authorities, have sufficient qualified staff. As Deputy Chair, I will dedicate attention and time to this crucial aspect.”

The Chair of the European Data Protection Board, Anu Talus, stated: “I would like to thank the outgoing Deputy Chair, Aleid Wolfsen, for his dedication and contribution over the past years, which has helped us as a Board to grow together and achieve excellent results. I look forward to collaborating with Deputy Chair Zdravko Vukić as we face the challenge of an increasing number of tasks for the European Data Protection Board.”

In accordance with Article 73 of the General Data Protection Regulation, the Board elects one Chair and two Deputy Chairs from among its members by a simple majority and through secret ballot. The term of office for the Chair and Deputy Chairs lasts for five years and may be extended once.